In Response to Columbine

By Janet O'Neill

The scene sets-up like this:

Shooters –
up the hill

on their knees

guns cocked and ready.

Students -

exit from

south door.
Downhill.

Teachers -
leading the students out to battle.
Pack leaders.
Coordinators.

Then
1 - the first shot
2 - the reaction
3 - the instinct to run away

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4 - the frenzy for survival
5 - the aftermath

OK, let's run it
live in 5
4
3
2
1.

INTRODUCTION

"In Response to Columbine" by Janet O'Neill

Where's he at?
He promised to help me
make my car
For the pinewood derby.
We're gonna win this year.
Where's dad?

OK.
It's an open-and-shut case.
Kid opens fire in the cafeteria.
Two second graders get glazed.
One third grader takes it in the vitals.

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Kid fleas the scene.
Has no escape plan.
Gets caught before he makes it to the ball diamond.
Motive?
Hell
We've got a cafeteria
filled with 246 witnesses.
We don't need motive.

Mommy
it's the new version.
The games so real it's
like you're actually there.
Can I have it?
Please?
I promise I'll be good.
If you get me this,
I won't be bored all summer.

It's like I don't
recognize her anymore.
She used to wear anything
GAP.
Now she wears anything
BLACK.
She comes home.
Goes to her room.

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Types on the computer.
I've noticed
cuts on her
arm.
First
they were small.
Now they're larger.
Gashes
in her
arm.
She's punishing
herself
She's punishing
me.
She's punishing
anything she can.
She breaks things.
Anything.
Supposedly she
keeps a journal.
I haven't read it
I won't.
But I want to know.
Where's my daughter?
Why won't she come back?

For every action

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there is an
equal
yet opposite
R
E
A
C
T
I
O
N
When it says here
"parents"
does that mean
my real parents
or the people I live
with?
Weekends, too?
Why can't I just
put grandma?
What if I don't know
their last name?
Can I leave it blank?
He's not really my dad.
He's like the guy
who lives with us, you know?
Can I leave it blank?

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No, I'm not buying you
a rifle for Christmas!
Well we can't have
everything Timmy has
can we?
Can we?
You answer your mother
when she's talking to you.
We can't have
everything Timmy has
can we?
Can we?

See I keep the money
underneath my sock.
Deep down.
Then before lunch
I go to the bathroom
and dig it out.
No one else can get it.
They're always taking my money.
They don't even need it.
They just want to get a
R R R
E E E
A A A

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C C C
T T T
I I I
O O O
N N N
out of me.

Tonight on "World's Toughest Men"
a man who took 4 bullets and lived
to tell the tale.

Today's topic:
Mothers who didn't
even know her child
was pregnant until she
brought home the baby.

Today - we celebrate
with a five-gun salute.

She's started to pull away.
Even more.
I found these brochures
for a private school
in Vermont.
She's telling her
friends that's where she's

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going.
Away.
She tells them.
She's going away.
If I read the diary. Just once
Would I find my daughter?
Would it be worth it
If
I
found my daughter?

For every action there is an
equal
yet opposite
R
E
A
C
T
I
O
N
I say we try the little f***er
as an adult.
Hell, I know he's only 13.
Little f***er knew.
He knew.

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And he knew you'd be too
Chicken**** to call him
on it.
Boys school 'til he's 18.
He knew.
Little f***er knew.

Daddy's playing cards tonight
Daddy just got home. He'll play later.
Daddy's out betting on horses
Out on vacation
Out of town
Out shooting baskets
out at the shooting range.
Daddy can I go?

Daddy can I go?

(Opens diary) Sometimes
I want to tell mom
about it.
But
she thinks Al's a good guy.
He's not like dad
she says
He's not like dad.
He scares me.

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I do what he tells me.
He says I better not
act like I'm asleep
and I don't
but I stay real quiet.
Real quiet.
Real quiet.
So mommy won't hear.
So mommy won't hear.
So mommy won't hear.
For every action
there is an
equal
yet opposite

R	R	R
E	E	E
A	A	A
C	C	C
T	T	T
I	I	I
O	O	O
N	N	N

Reaction to the shooting
were mixed, as the families
of the victims mourned
the death of their children

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and the families of the
perpetrators mourn the
death of their children's souls.
Next hour on Newsextra,
we'll talk to the town
rocked by the events of
today.
What triggered the attack?
Next, on Newsextra.
And we're out in
5
4
3
2
1.

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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